

A shikara on the Dal, Srinagar

The KASHMIRI Welcome

WHERE TO STAY WHEN YOU ARE IN JAMMU & KASHMIR

By **Shikha Tripathi**

At no point does the 'Kashmir is Paradise' cliché seem truer than in summer. The vistas are, of course, always a treat, but adding to the pleasures of J&K are hotels and guest houses, dotted right across the state. From houseboats to palaces (and everything in between) to choose from, our round-up of stay options is made to fit any budget. With the amount of comfort and luxury on offer, the state's new reputation of welcome and hospitality is making it altogether impossible to again dismiss it as hostile.

JAMMU & KASHMIR

SRINAGAR

Nadis

Close to the Mughal gardens, the green Harwan village is a gateway to the Dachigam National Park. Here you'll find Nadis, a contemporary, chic boutique stay. A refreshing change from usual suspects, Nadis is brightly lit, has large rooms and common spaces that feature art inspired by Kashmir's alpine landscapes. The food is typically Kashmiri, marked by an abundance of cinnamon, saffron, dried nuts and fruit. The place overlooks a huge private garden where you can sometimes feel a gentle breeze in the afternoons and smell a whiff of the paradise that is Kashmir. *(nadis-hotel.com; INR 8,100 with breakfast and taxes)*

Karan Mahal

Once home to Dr Karan Singh, former governor and son of Maharaja Hari Singh, this erstwhile Raj Bhawan has hosted several prominent figures throughout its history. Having undergone an extensive decade-long renovation, Karan Mahal opened its doors to tourists in 2021. Showcasing both vintage European influence and Kashmiri heritage, the building also overlooks a large, private orchard that